

1658 Sweden gains the Skane and Blekinge regions of southern Sweden and also, for two years, Trondheim from Denmark–Norway.

1660 The Peace of Copenhagen confirms Sweden's empire, which includes Finland, Estonia, Ingria, Livonia, and Pomerania, and several other possessions in Germany.

1679 Under the "reduction" Charles XI (1660–97) breaks the power of the nobility and establishes an absolute monarchy with the support of the Riksdag (parliament).

1721 The Treaty of Nystad, at the end of the Great Northern War (1700–21), marks the end of Sweden as a major power; it loses its Baltic empire to Russia.

1723 A constitution is adopted that subordinates the crown to parliament, although absolute rule is partially reasserted under Gustav III, who rules from 1771 until 1792.

1809 Sweden is obliged to cede Finland to Russia; a new parliamentary constitution is adopted later in the year.



Gustavus II Adolphus

King of Sweden from 1611–32, Gustavus led a formidably experienced and well-equipped army into Germany in 1630 that turned the tide of the 30 Years War against the Catholic nations.

1814–15 Congress of Vienna. Sweden cedes territory to Russia and Denmark.

1865–66 Riksdag (parliament) reformed into a bicameral structure.

1905 Norway gains independence from Sweden.

1914–18 Sweden remains neutral during World War I but supplies Germany, leading to an Allied blockade.

1917 The new Liberal government limits exports contributing to German war effort.

1919 Universal adult suffrage.

1921 Finland gains Åland Islands as retribution for Sweden's war role.

1932 Severe recession. Social Democrat (SAP) government under Per Albin Hansson is elected.

1939–45 Sweden neutral in World War II, but grants transit rights to German forces.

1945–69 Continuing Social Democratic (SSA) rule makes Sweden the world's most advanced welfare state.

1950 Gustav VI Adolf becomes king.

1953 Nordic Council member.

1960 Joins European Free Trade Area.

1969 Olof Palme becomes prime minister, losing power in 1976.

1973 Carl XVI Gustav on throne.

1975 Major constitutional reform: the Riksdag becomes unicameral with a three-year term. Role of monarchy reduced to ceremonial functions.

1982 Olof Palme forms government.

1986 Palme shot dead. His deputy, Ingvar Carlsson, succeeds him as prime minister. Police fail to find the killer.

1990 Carlsson introduces moderate austerity package, cuts government spending, raises indirect taxes.

1991 SSA remains largest party after a general election but is unable to form a government; Carlsson resigns. Carl Bildt, leader of the Moderate Party (MS), forms coalition of nonsocialist parties.

1992 Austerity measures succeed in reducing inflation but SSA refuses to support further spending cuts.

1995 Joins EU.

1996 Carlsson resigns; replaced by Göran Persson (to 2006).

1999 Swedish cabinet first in world to have a majority of women. Foreign minister Anna Lindh is stabbed to death.

2003 Referendum rejects the euro.

2006 Moderate Party under Frederick Reinfeldt returns to power.

2010 Anti-immigration Swedish Democrats become the first far-right party to enter the Swedish parliament.

«186–87 The Black Death
«202–03 Raiders and Traders
«262–63 The 30 Years War
«272–73 Masters of War

Denmark



The most southerly Scandinavian nation, once united with Norway, Iceland, and Sweden.

800s The Dan people or Danes, who originally came from southern Sweden, join other Viking groups in seaborne conquest across Europe and beyond.



Model occupation

German troops invaded Denmark on April 9, 1940. Unlike other occupied countries, Denmark's institutions continued to function as normal. The Nazis considered it a model occupation until a wave of strikes and protests prompted them to take full command.

c.980 Harald Bluetooth establishes unified Danish kingdom.

1000s Christianity is main religion.

1016–35 Canute the Great unites all of Scandinavia and England under his rule.

1157–82 Denmark's ascendancy within Scandinavia is reasserted during the reign of Valdemar the Great.

1396 Union of Kalmar unites Norway, Iceland, and Sweden (including Finland) in a personal union under Danish crown; Sweden and Finland secede in 1523.

1448 Christian I ascends throne as the first monarch of Oldenburg royal house.

1533–36 A civil war leads to the establishment of Evangelical Lutheranism as the state religion.

1660 A new constitution sponsored by Frederick III breaks privileges of nobility and establishes an absolute monarchy.

1814 Denmark, an ally of France, loses its remaining German possessions and cedes Norway to Sweden.

1849 First democratic constitution.

1864 Denmark forced to cede Schleswig and Holstein after losing war with Prussia.

1914–18 Neutral in World War I.

1920 Northern Schleswig votes to return to Danish rule.

1924 First Social Democratic (SD) government takes power and introduces advanced social welfare legislation.

1939–45 World War II: Denmark is neutral, but Germany invades in 1940. When the Nazis impose anti-Semitic laws, Danish seafarers ferry all but 500 of Denmark's 8,400 Jews to Sweden.

1944 Iceland declares independence from Denmark.

1945 After the defeat of Germany, SD leads post-war coalition governments.

1953 A single-chamber, proportionally elected parliament is created.

1960 Denmark joins the European Free Trade Association (EFTA).

1975–82 SD's Anker Jorgensen heads series of coalitions.

1982–93 Poul Schlüter is the first Conservative prime minister since 1901, in coalition with the Liberals.

2000 Referendum rejects joining euro.

2006 Cartoons of Prophet Muhammad published in a Danish newspaper spark protests in Muslim countries.

2009 Denmark hosts the UN climate change summit at Copenhagen.

«202–03 Raiders and Traders
«256–59 The Reformation
«262–63 The 30 Years War

DENMARK

SELF-GOVERNING TERRITORIES

FAEROE ISLANDS

Group of islands in the North Atlantic.
700s Irish monks first settle the Faeroes; Norwegian Vikings follow in 800.
1035 Formally a Norwegian possession.
1396 Along with Norway, the Faeroes become part of Denmark, and remain so when Norway joins Sweden in 1814.
1816 Faeroes are made an administrative district of Denmark.
1852 The regional parliament is restored but only as a consultative body.
1940–45 British troops occupy Faeroes.
1948 Denmark grants home rule.
1972 Islands vote not to join EC.

GREENLAND

World's largest island, in the North Atlantic.
989 Settled by Eric the Red.
1262 Greenland formally becomes a Norwegian possession.
1396 Along with Norway, Greenland becomes part of Denmark.
1953 New Danish constitution fully integrates Greenland into Danish kingdom.
1973 Joins EC with Denmark despite voting no in a referendum.
1979 Denmark grants home rule.
1985 Leaves the European Community.
2008 Referendum votes for greater autonomy from Denmark.